

TO INFINITY AND BEYOND!

Pioneering women haven't just shone a bright light in computing or information technology alone. Take a look at the following inventions, all of which come down to the efforts of enterprising females



Windshield wiper – Not many people know this, but the first effective working model of the modern day car windshield wiper was made by Mary Anderson, when she was driving to New York City on a frosty day and noticed other motorists struggling to drive with the snow falling on their windshields. She received a patent for her invention in 1903.

Electric Refrigerator – If it weren't for Florence Parpart's invention, the electric fridge, we'd still need to wait for our daily delivery of ice to preserve household food items, because that's how refrigerators used to work till about 1914 – when Parpart had her eureka moment. Thanks to her invention, billions of tonnes of food are preserved and prevented from wastage in households around the world.



Kevlar – A whole new world of rich polymer chemistry would've been hidden away from us, but for the efforts of Stephanie Kwolek, a scientist and chemist. While working for DuPont, in 1964, Kwolek invented 'Kevlar'

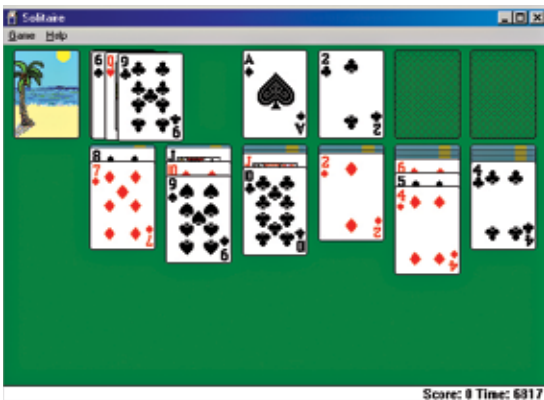
– a polymer that's five times stronger than steel by weight. Kevlar is used to build aeroplanes, sports equipment, boats and, of course, bulletproof vests.



CCTV – Unmanned, device-only constant surveillance solutions are a dime a dozen now. However, back in 1966, the concept was unimaginable. Growing up in New York City, Marie Van Brittan Brown dreamt the impossible and devised a solution that allowed her to attach a camera to a pole and view its feed on a monitor display. Not only this, her CCTV invention also allowed

for authorised personnel to open a security door with the click of a remote controller.

Browser for Blind – Chieko Asakawa holds the distinction for creating many pathbreaking solutions for the blind or vision-impaired to facilitate their access to technology. In 1997, her work on the groundbreaking voice browser – 'IBM Home Page Reader', which was made available in the U.S., Europe and Asia – opened up the Web and its information resources to the blind. Its interface technology has been widely adopted by other voice browsers.



Susan Kare is credited for Solitaire's UI

delivered an inexpensive, high-volume production computer that many technology titans at the time thought was an impossible dream.

Dr. Jepsen then went on to found 'Pixel Qi Corp.' in 2008, with a vision to trans-

form the display industry by building a revolutionary new display that performed incredibly well while viewing its content under direct sunlight – a feat that many modern displays still grapple to overcome. In the past, she's been a professor at MIT, the CTO of Intel's Display Division and, most recently, been involved with Google X as the Head of its Display Division, directing display and consumer electronic programs throughout Google.

Dr. Jepsen's current challenge? As executive at Facebook/ Oculus VR, she is leading a concerted effort to bring Virtual Reality to the next level. With her extensive background in display technology pioneering, we have no doubt she'll play



Thank Dr. Jepsen for One laptop per child

a crucial role in ensuring VR reaches unprecedented heights in the coming months. Time Magazine inducted her into its "Time 100" as one of the 100 most influential people in the world, and who would argue with that? 